

Carbon farming

'Carbon farming' describes agricultural and land management activities that help mitigate climate change by:

- reducing emissions of the main GHGs: methane, nitrous oxide and carbon dioxide, by avoiding or minimising them
- storing more carbon — also called sequestering carbon — which means capturing and removing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere and storing carbon in 'carbon sinks': vegetation and soil. Carbon is stored in land and coastal ecosystems (such as mangroves).

Each carbon sink stores carbon differently. For example:

- in vegetation (such as trees and grasslands), carbon is stored in the stems, trunks and roots
- in soil, carbon is stored in living and dead organic material.

Topic 2 looks at the carbon farming activities in the following table.

Carbon farming activities

Group	Activity
Soil	Conservation and strategic tillage
	Crop and pasture management
	Efficient fertiliser use
	Reduce beef and dairy cattle and sheep methane emissions
Livestock	Manage piggery and dairy effluent
	Grazing management
	Afforestation
Vegetation	Reforestation
	Agroforestry
	Retain existing native vegetation
Blue carbon	Restore wetlands, saltmarsh and seagrass
	Remove or modify barriers to tidal flow

First Nations traditional ecological
practices

Cultural burning, including savanna fire management

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/climatechange/carbon-farming-outreach-program/training-package/topic-1/carbon-farming-reduces-emissions-stores-carbon>